

LHC powers down for 2 years

Citing repairs and maintenance work, CERN's Large Hadron Collider, where the Higgs Boson was discovered, will experience some scheduled downtime. <http://digit.in/13pG0Wq>



Steam for Linux

Valve officially launched its revered cloud gaming service, Steam, for Linux with a number of games sold at 50 to 75% discount

Sony Alpha-99

Impressive full-frame SLT with good low-light performance

The Sony Alpha SLT-99 is the replacement for the A-900, Sony's first full-frame camera and is a camera done right in so many ways.

Given the full frame sensor, the Alpha 99 does exhibit excellent dynamic range and colour depth, but what we found particularly impressive was the high ISO performance. Despite hitting the ISO 8000 mark for most of our low light shooting, we found our images to not have any chroma noise, with very low magnitude luminance noise, meaning that it had a very fine grain texture. We found that such images, when converted to black and white ended up having a really nice "classic film" look. We noticed hardly any noise develop when shooting in the streets at night.

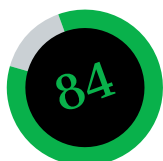


Price
₹1,79,990
(body only)

The A-99 has 19 AF points, with 11 cross type, but for some reason, all of them are packed very close to each other in the centre of the frame. We found this to be severely limiting with respect to framing subjects that were in the corner of the frame. Initially, we found the AF to be a bit slow when compared to the Canon USM or Nikon SWM counterparts, but after updating the firmware to version 1.01, AF with the same Zeiss 24-70mm f/2.8 and Zeiss 135mm f/1.8 was noticeably faster. The focus hunting was significantly reduced and the tracking worked like a charm and the 102 AF assist points really made sure our subject did not go out of focus.

The full magnesium alloy construction coupled up with an extensive weather sealing network makes the Alpha-99 incredibly rugged and fit for all weather shooting. We managed to get off about 500 shots and a few minutes' worth of video before the battery completely died on us. Regardless, we've loved shooting with the Alpha-99 and coupled up with the Zeiss glass, the images out of this camera are simply astounding.

Swapnil Mathur



Features	85
Performance.....	90
Build Quality	95
Value for money	65

Specifications

Sensor: 24 megapixels Full Frame;
Lens: Sony/Minolta A Mount;
Maximum Burst Mode: 6 fps; **Movie Resolution:** 1920x1080 at 60, 24fps

Contact

Sony India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 1800-103-7799
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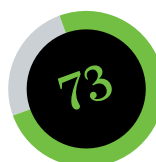
IRISCard Anywhere 4

Effortless way to digitise business cards



Price
₹10,999

It's a business card scanner with an internal memory of 512MB expandable with SD card or USB drive which can also work on battery. Scanning of cards was quick with a three second interval between successive card scans. Cardiris Pro 5 utility uses IRIS's optical character recognition and can fill up the card details under relevant headings such as Name, Address, Title, Phone, etc. The OCR wasn't 100 per cent accurate if the concerned title has any design element around it. You also have the ability to correct the recognised title. Finally you can export all your card details in a variety of formats. Ideal for users who want to digitise visiting cards with utmost ease.



Features	80
Performance.....	80
Build Quality	70
Value for money.....	60

Specifications

Resolution: 300 dpi; **Document size:** 4 x 6 inches; **Interface:** SD,xD,MS,MS Pro,MMC, USB; **Output File format:** JPEG; **Internal memory:** 512 MB; **Weight:** 230 grams

Contact

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ECS Z77H2-A3

Ideal candidate for a budget Intel build



Price
₹5,800

The ECS Z77H2-A3 comes in an all-black body. The heatsink around the VRM is not that impressive. With just a single PCIe x16 slot and four PCIe x1 slots and two PCI slots, this board is definitely meant for entry-level to mid-range use. We also noticed more electrolytic capacitors than solid state caps. Build quality isn't the best and it has a four-pin power connector on board. Overclocking was decent, but not the best. Benchmark scores were in line with other Z77 boards. One of the cheapest Z77 boards we have seen in recent times. It is ideal for someone looking to build a budget Intel rig.



Features	60
Overclocking.....	50
Build Quality	50
Value for money.....	75

Specifications

Chipset: Intel Z77; **PCIe x16 slots:** 1; **SATA 6 Gbps ports:** 2; **USB 3.0 ports:** 2; **Audio:** Realtek ALC892; **Display Ports:** 1xDVI, 1xD-Sub; **Form Factor:** ATX

Contact

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